



PROITBRIDGE
Strive For Better Future

PEOPLE • POLICIES • PRACTICES

Employee Handbook

Everything you need to know about working at PROITBRIDGE — how we hire, how we pay, how we grow, how we protect our people and our clients, and what we expect from each other, every single day.

DOCUMENT	Employee Handbook — All Employees
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APPLIES TO	All full-time, part-time, contract and intern staff in India
OWNER	Human Resources Department, PROITBRIDGE
REVIEW CYCLE	Annually, or on any change in applicable law
CLASSIFICATION	Internal — Confidential

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CHAPTER 01

Welcome to PROITBRIDGE

A message from the Founder & Chief Executive Officer.

Dear Colleague,

Welcome to **PROITBRIDGE**. Whether you have joined us as a fresh graduate taking your first step into the technology industry, or as an experienced engineer, trainer or business leader, you are now part of a company that exists for one reason: to bridge the gap between where talent is today and where the industry needs it to be tomorrow.

When we started PROITBRIDGE, the problem we set out to solve was simple to describe and hard to fix. Thousands of capable people were being left behind, not because they lacked intelligence or effort, but because nobody had shown them the practical path from theory to a real job. We built this company to be that path — through training, through consulting, and through building real AI products that our learners can see, touch and learn from.

You will hear me say one thing often: **outcomes over activity**. We are not measured by how many hours we sit at a desk. We are measured by whether a learner got placed, whether a client's system went live, whether a model actually works in production. That is the standard we hold ourselves to, and it is the standard this handbook is written to support.

This handbook tells you what you can expect from PROITBRIDGE and what PROITBRIDGE expects from you. Please read it fully. It covers your pay, your leave, your benefits, your safety and your rights — and it also covers the conduct, confidentiality and security obligations that protect our learners, our clients and each other.

If anything in these pages is unclear, or if something here does not match what you are experiencing on the ground, do not stay silent. Talk to your manager, talk to HR, or write to me directly. A policy that people cannot follow is a policy we need to fix.

You were not hired to fill a seat. You were hired because we believe you can build something that outlasts you. **Do work you would be proud to sign.**

Warm regards,

John Gabriel

Founder & Chief Executive Officer, PROITBRIDGE Technologies Private Limited

What This Handbook Will Do For You

Answer Your Questions

Leave balance, salary date, insurance claim, notice period, reimbursement limits — the answers are here, written down, so you never have to guess or rely on hearsay.

Set Clear Expectations

You will know exactly what good conduct, good security practice and good performance look like at PROITBRIDGE, and how they are measured and rewarded.

Protect You

Anti-harassment, grievance redressal, safety and statutory benefits are documented so your rights do not depend on who your manager happens to be.

Protect Our Clients

Our clients trust us with sensitive data and business-critical systems. The security and confidentiality chapters explain the obligations that keep that trust intact.

Your First 30 Days — At a Glance

Timeline	What Happens	Who Owns It
Day 0	Offer acceptance, document submission, background verification initiated	HR Operations
Day 1	Welcome session, ID card, email and system credentials, asset handover	HR + IT
Day 1–2	Induction: company overview, policies, security training, POSH briefing	HR
Day 3–5	Team introduction, buddy assignment, tools and repository access	Reporting Manager
Week 2	First goals set in the performance system; project or batch allocation	Reporting Manager
Week 4	30-day check-in with HR and manager; early feedback both ways	HR Business Partner
Day 90	Probation review discussion and confirmation decision	Manager + HR

i Where to find this document

Keep a copy of this handbook accessible. It is also available on the HR portal at people.proitbridge.com/handbook, where the version published online is always the one in force.

CHAPTER 02

About the Company

Who we are, what we believe, how we are organised, and where we are going.

Company Profile

Registered name	PROITBRIDGE Technologies Private Limited
Incorporated	2019, under the Companies Act, 2013
Registered office	3rd Floor, Prestige Tech Park, Outer Ring Road, Bengaluru – 560103, Karnataka, India
Additional locations	Chennai (delivery centre), Hyderabad (sales), Coimbatore (studio), remote-first teams across India
Business lines	Ed-tech training & placement, AI/Data consulting services, digital content and media, product engineering
Headcount	Approximately 520 employees across four locations (as of 1 April 2026)
Working languages	English (official business language); Tamil, Hindi and Kannada used regionally

Our Vision

i Vision

To become India's most trusted bridge between capable people and the technology careers they deserve — so that talent, not background, decides who gets the job.

Our Mission

- **Teach what the industry actually uses.** Every curriculum is rebuilt against live job descriptions at least twice a year, not left to age quietly.
- **Prove it with placement.** We measure ourselves on learners placed and salary uplift achieved, not on courses sold.
- **Build alongside teaching.** Our consulting and product teams ship real systems, and those systems become the case studies our learners train on.
- **Keep it affordable and honest.** No inflated promises, no hidden fees, no fabricated placement statistics.

Our Core Values

These six values are not decoration. They are used in hiring interviews, in performance reviews and in disciplinary decisions. When two values appear to conflict, integrity wins.

1 Integrity Before Everything

We tell learners, clients and each other the truth — including the inconvenient truth. We never inflate numbers, never misrepresent a candidate's skills, and never hide a mistake to protect ourselves.

2 Outcomes Over Activity

Effort matters, but results are what change someone's life. We plan backwards from the outcome the learner or client needs, and we measure the outcome, not the hours spent.

3 Learn Relentlessly

Our field reinvents itself every few months. Everyone at PROITBRIDGE — including leadership — is expected to be actively learning something new each quarter and to share it with the team.

4 Own It End to End

“That is not my department” is not an acceptable answer. If you see a problem, you own it until it is either solved or formally handed to someone who has accepted it.

5 Respect the Person

Every learner, colleague, vendor and client is treated with dignity regardless of designation, background, gender, language or seniority. Rudeness is a performance issue, not a personality trait.

6 Guard What Is Entrusted

Client data, learner data and company IP are held in trust. Protecting them is part of every role, not just the IT team's job.

How We Are Organised

Function	What It Does	Led By
Academy & Delivery	Curriculum design, live training batches, mentoring, learner assessment	VP – Academy
Placements & Careers	Employer partnerships, resume and interview preparation, placement drives	Head – Placements
Consulting & Engineering	Client AI/data projects, platform engineering, managed services	VP – Engineering
Product	Internal learning platform, assessment engine, AI tooling	Head – Product
Content & Media	Video production, social channels, brand and marketing content	Head – Content
Sales & Growth	B2C admissions counselling, B2B corporate training, partnerships	VP – Growth
People (HR)	Hiring, onboarding, payroll, engagement, policy and compliance	Head – People
Finance & Legal	Accounting, statutory compliance, contracts, procurement	Head – Finance
IT & Information Security	Infrastructure, devices, access control, security operations	Manager – IT & Security

Our Code in One Line

Do the right thing, especially when it is expensive, slow or nobody is watching.

CHAPTER 03
How to Use This Handbook

Scope, legal standing, interpretation, amendments and the limits of this document.

Purpose

This handbook consolidates the people policies of PROITBRIDGE Technologies Private Limited into a single reference. It is designed so that any employee, at any location, can find the applicable rule without needing to ask a colleague or rely on informal precedent.

Who This Handbook Applies To

Category	Covered by this Handbook?	Notes
Full-time permanent employees	Yes — entirely	All chapters apply from date of joining.
Employees on probation	Yes	Leave entitlement and notice period differ — see Chapters 4 and 7.
Part-time employees	Yes, pro-rated	Benefits and leave are pro-rated to contracted hours.
Fixed-term contract staff	Yes, except benefits	Statutory benefits apply; discretionary perks per contract.
Interns and trainees	Conduct and security chapters apply	Stipend, leave and duration governed by the internship letter.
Consultants and vendor staff	Conduct, safety and security chapters apply	Commercial terms governed by the services agreement.

Relationship With Your Employment Contract

Your individual appointment letter, together with any annexures and the applicable law of India, forms your contract of employment. Where a specific term of your appointment letter conflicts with this handbook, the appointment letter prevails for that term. Where any provision of this handbook conflicts with a statutory requirement, the statute prevails and the affected clause is deemed modified to the minimum extent necessary to comply.

⚠ Important — legal status

This handbook is a statement of policy and practice. It is not a contract of employment and does not create a guarantee of employment for any specific period. Nothing in it limits either party's rights under the appointment letter or applicable law.

Amendments

- Policies are reviewed at least once a year by the People function, and immediately whenever an applicable law changes.
- Material changes are communicated by email to all affected employees at least 15 calendar days before they take effect, except where a legal change requires faster adoption.

- The version published on the HR portal is always the authoritative version. Printed or downloaded copies may be out of date.
- Version history is maintained on the portal so you can see exactly what changed and when.

Interpretation and Escalation

If you believe a policy is being applied inconsistently, or a situation is not covered here, raise it in this order:

1. Your reporting manager — for day-to-day interpretation.
2. Your HR Business Partner — for policy clarification, in writing.
3. Head – People — for a formal interpretation, which is binding and documented.
4. For matters involving harassment, safety, fraud or ethics, skip the chain entirely and use the routes described in Chapters 15 and 16.

Definitions Used Throughout

Term	Meaning in this handbook
Company / PROITBRIDGE	PROITBRIDGE Technologies Private Limited and its subsidiaries.
Employee / you	Any person employed by the Company under a contract of service in India.
Management	Employees at Manager grade and above with people or budget responsibility.
HR / People	The Human Resources function of the Company.
Working day	Monday to Friday, excluding declared company holidays.
Calendar day	Every day including weekends and holidays.
CTC	Cost to Company — total annual cost of your employment, including employer contributions.
Confidential Information	Any non-public information of the Company, its clients, learners or partners.
IC	Internal Committee constituted under the POSH Act, 2013.

CHAPTER 04

Employment Policies

Categories of employment, equal opportunity, background verification, probation, confirmation and internal movement.

4.1 Categories of Employment

Category	Definition	Leave	Notice Period
Permanent — Confirmed	Full-time employee who has cleared probation	Full entitlement	60 days
Permanent — On Probation	Full-time employee within the probation period	Casual + Sick only	30 days
Fixed-Term Contract	Employed for a defined period or project	Statutory + pro-rated CL	30 days
Part-Time	Contracted for fewer than 40 hours per week	Pro-rated	30 days
Intern / Trainee	Student or graduate on a structured internship	1 day per completed month	15 days
Retainer / Consultant	Engaged under a services contract, not an employee	Not applicable	Per contract

4.2 Equal Employment Opportunity

PROITBRIDGE is an equal opportunity employer. All employment decisions — hiring, compensation, training, promotion, transfer, discipline and separation — are made solely on the basis of merit, qualification, business need and demonstrated performance.

We do not discriminate on the basis of:

- Religion, caste, community or place of birth
- Race, colour, ethnicity, nationality or language
- Sex, gender identity, gender expression or sexual orientation
- Marital status, pregnancy, or family or caregiving responsibilities
- Age, physical ability or medical condition (subject to the genuine requirements of the role)
- Political affiliation or membership of any lawful association

i Reasonable accommodation

In line with the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016, PROITBRIDGE provides reasonable accommodation to employees and candidates with disabilities. Requests may be made confidentially to your HR Business Partner at any stage, including during the interview process.

4.3 Recruitment and Selection

- All open roles are published internally on the HR portal for at least **five working days** before external sourcing begins, so existing employees can apply first.
- Every candidate goes through a structured process: screening, at least one technical or functional round, a values interview, and an HR discussion.
- Interview panels of three or more must include at least one member from outside the hiring team.

- Interview feedback is recorded in the applicant tracking system within 24 hours. Verbal –only decisions are not permitted.
- Employment of relatives is permitted, but a relative may not be in the reporting line of, or on the selection panel for, the employee concerned. Existing relationships must be declared to HR in writing.

4.4 Background Verification

All offers of employment are conditional on satisfactory background verification, carried out by an accredited agency with your written consent. Verification covers:

Check	What Is Verified	Typical Turnaround
Identity	Government-issued photo ID and address proof	2 working days
Education	Highest qualification, from the issuing institution or registry	7–15 working days
Employment	Last two employers — dates, designation, reason for leaving	7–15 working days
Criminal record	Court records at present and permanent address	10–20 working days
Reference	Two professional references from previous supervisors	5 working days

⚠ Falsification of records

A deliberate misrepresentation or omission in your application, CV or declarations — including inflated designations, fabricated experience or undisclosed parallel employment — is treated as fraud and will result in withdrawal of the offer or termination for cause, at whatever stage it is discovered.

4.5 Probation and Confirmation

Standard probation	90 calendar days from date of joining
Leadership roles (Manager and above)	180 calendar days
Extension	May be extended once, by up to 90 days, with written reasons shared with you
During probation	Casual and Sick Leave only; Earned Leave accrues but cannot be availed
Confirmation	Confirmed in writing by HR after a documented review with your manager
Notice during probation	30 days on either side, or salary in lieu

Confirmation is not automatic. Your manager completes a probation review covering delivery against your first-90-day goals, working style, values alignment and attendance. You will receive the outcome in writing within 10 working days of your probation end date. If you do not receive a decision by then, your employment is deemed confirmed.

4.6 Internal Transfers and Job Rotation

- You become eligible to apply for internal openings after **12 months** in your current role (9 months for lateral moves within the same function).
- You must be confirmed, not on a Performance Improvement Plan, and not under any active disciplinary proceeding.
- Inform your current manager before the second interview round. Managers may not block an internal application; they may request a transition period of up to 45 days.

- Compensation is reviewed only if the new role sits in a higher grade. A lateral move does not automatically change your pay.

4.7 Secondary Employment and Moonlighting

Full-time employees may not take up any other employment, consulting engagement, directorship or business that competes with PROITBRIDGE, uses Company time or assets, or creates a conflict of interest.

Allowed Without Approval

Teaching a personal course on a topic unrelated to your PROITBRIDGE work, publishing books or articles, open-source contributions in personal time, passive investments, and unpaid community or charitable roles.

Requires Written Approval

Any paid external work, advisory or board position, freelance delivery for a client in our market, or content on the same subject matter you teach or deliver here. Apply to your Function Head with a copy to HR.

CHAPTER 05

Joining & Onboarding

Your documents, your first days, your buddy, your assets and your induction plan.

5.1 Documents to Submit on or Before Day 1

- ☐ Signed appointment letter (all pages initialled)
- ☐ PAN card copy and Aadhaar card copy
- ☐ Passport-size photographs (two, recent)
- ☐ All education certificates and consolidated mark sheets
- ☐ Relieving letter and experience letter from your previous employer
- ☐ Last three months' salary slips and last Form 16 (for tax computation)
- ☐ Cancelled cheque or bank passbook copy for salary credit
- ☐ UAN number and previous PF account details, if any
- ☐ Nomination forms for PF, gratuity and group insurance
- ☐ Emergency contact details and blood group
- ☐ Signed Non-Disclosure Agreement and IT acceptable-use undertaking

Why this matters

Missing documents delay payroll setup, PF registration and insurance enrolment. If a document is genuinely unavailable (for example, a pending university convocation), submit a written undertaking with a committed date — do not simply omit it.

5.2 The Induction Programme

Session	Duration	Conducted By	Covers
Welcome & company overview	60 min	HR	History, vision, values, business lines, org structure
Policy walkthrough	90 min	HR	This handbook — leave, payroll, conduct, benefits
Information security induction	60 min	IT & Security	Acceptable use, passwords, phishing, client data, AI tools
POSH awareness (mandatory)	45 min	IC Presiding Officer	POSH Act, what constitutes harassment, how to complain
Safety & emergency briefing	30 min	Admin	Exits, assembly point, first aid, incident reporting
Tools & systems setup	60 min	IT	Email, HRMS, project tools, VPN, repository access
Function deep-dive	Half day	Function Head	How your function works, key metrics, current priorities
Meet the founder	45 min	CEO	Monthly cohort session — direct Q&A, no agenda

5.3 The Buddy Programme

Every new joiner is assigned a **buddy** — a peer from a nearby team, never your own manager. Your buddy is your safe place to ask questions you feel are too basic to ask anyone else.

- Your buddy will reach out on Day 1 and meet you at least weekly for the first six weeks.
- Buddies do not evaluate you and do not report on you. Conversations with your buddy are not part of your probation review.
- If the pairing is not working, tell HR. You will be reassigned with no explanation required and no record kept.

5.4 Company Assets Issued to You

Asset	Standard Issue	Refresh Cycle	Your Responsibility
Laptop	Role-appropriate machine with full-disk encryption	36 months	Keep encrypted, patched and physically secure
Access card	Photo ID with building and floor access	On damage or loss	Never share; report loss within 4 hours
Headset / peripherals	For trainer, support and content roles	24 months	Return on separation
Mobile / data allowance	For field, sales and on-call roles	Per policy	Business use; bills submitted monthly
Software licences	Named-user licences assigned to you	Annual review	Do not share credentials or install unlicensed software

⚠ Asset accountability

All assets remain the property of PROITBRIDGE and must be returned in working condition on your last working day. Unreturned or wilfully damaged assets are recovered at depreciated book value from your full-and-final settlement.

5.5 Your First 90 Days — What Good Looks Like

Days 1–30 — Absorb

Complete all induction sessions. Understand your team's goals and your own. Meet every stakeholder you will work with. Ask more questions than you answer.

Days 31–60 — Contribute

Own at least one deliverable end to end. Work independently on routine tasks. Give your first piece of constructive feedback to the team.

Days 61–90 — Deliver

Deliver measurable output against your goals without close supervision, identify one process that could be improved and propose a fix, and go into your probation review with evidence rather than explanations.

CHAPTER 06

Working Hours & Attendance

Standard hours, shifts, flexibility, attendance recording, punctuality and overtime.

6.1 Standard Working Hours

Standard week	Monday to Friday, 40 hours
Standard day	9 hours including a 1-hour break — typically 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM IST
Core hours	11:00 AM to 4:00 PM IST — you must be available and reachable
Flexi window	Start any time between 8:00 AM and 10:30 AM, with your manager's agreement
Weekly off	Saturday and Sunday, except for declared batch weekends and shift roles
Lunch break	45–60 minutes, staggered within the team so coverage is maintained

We care about outcomes, not chair time. Provided you are present in core hours, meet your commitments and keep your calendar accurate, you have real flexibility over when you start and finish.

6.2 Shift Roles

Shift	Timing (IST)	Applies To	Shift Allowance
General	9:30 AM – 6:30 PM	Most functions	Nil
Early	7:00 AM – 4:00 PM	APAC client support	₹ 3,000 / month
Evening	2:00 PM – 11:00 PM	EMEA support, evening batches	₹ 5,000 / month
Night	9:00 PM – 6:00 AM	US client delivery, NOC	₹ 9,000 / month + cab both ways
Weekend batch	9:00 AM – 6:00 PM Sat/ Sun	Academy trainers	Compensatory off + ₹ 2,000 / day

- Shift rosters are published at least **14 days** in advance and may not be changed within 72 hours except by mutual consent.
- No employee may be rostered for more than 5 consecutive night shifts, or for a night shift immediately followed by a general shift.
- Women employees working between 8:00 PM and 6:00 AM are provided secure door-to-door transport with a security escort, as required under applicable state rules, and may opt out of night shifts without any adverse consequence.

6.3 Attendance Recording

- Attendance is captured through the access-card reader at office locations and through the HRMS web or mobile check-in for remote and field work.
- Check in when you begin work and check out when you finish. Do not check in on behalf of a colleague — proxy attendance is a disciplinary offence.
- Regularise any missed punch within **3 working days** in the HRMS. Unregularised days beyond the cut-off are treated as Loss of Pay.

- The attendance month runs from the 21st of one month to the 20th of the next, aligning with the payroll cycle.

6.4 Punctuality and Late Arrival

Occurrence in a Month	Consequence
Up to 3 late arrivals (within 30 minutes of your agreed start)	No action — treated as normal variation
4–6 late arrivals	Conversation with your reporting manager, noted informally
7–9 late arrivals	Written counselling note from HR; half-day Loss of Pay for every third instance
10 or more late arrivals	Formal warning; considered in the performance review
Late arrival for a scheduled training batch or client call	Treated separately — a single instance triggers a manager discussion

i Flexi-time and punctuality

Punctuality is judged against your agreed start time, not a fixed 9:30 AM. If you have agreed a 10:30 AM start with your manager, arriving at 10:30 AM is on time. Record the agreement in the HRMS so attendance reports reflect it.

6.5 Absence Without Information

- If you cannot come to work, inform your manager before your shift begins — a call or message, not an unread email.
- Absence of **3 consecutive working days** without information triggers a written contact attempt to your registered address and emergency contact.
- Absence of **8 consecutive working days** without information may be treated as voluntary abandonment of employment, after a show-cause notice and a 7-day window to respond.

6.6 Overtime and Compensatory Off

- PROITBRIDGE does not run on overtime. Sustained overtime is a planning failure and should be escalated, not normalised.
- Employees in non-exempt categories are paid overtime at **twice the ordinary rate** for hours worked beyond 48 in a week, in line with applicable law.
- For all other employees, work on a weekly off or declared holiday earns **compensatory off**, credited within 3 working days and valid for 90 days.
- Compensatory off must be pre-approved by your manager before the extra work, not claimed afterwards.

CHAPTER 07

Leave Policy

Every leave type, how much you get, how it accrues, and how to apply.

7.1 Leave Entitlement Summary

Leave Type	Entitlement per Year	Accrual	Carry Forward	Encashable
Earned / Privilege Leave (EL)	18 days	1.5 days per completed month	Up to 45 days	Yes, on separation
Casual Leave (CL)	8 days	Credited upfront on 1 January	No — lapses	No
Sick Leave (SL)	10 days	Credited upfront on 1 January	Up to 20 days	No
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	On qualifying event	Not applicable	No
Paternity Leave	10 working days	On qualifying event	Not applicable	No
Adoption / Commissioning Leave	12 weeks	On qualifying event	Not applicable	No
Bereavement Leave	5 days per event	On qualifying event	Not applicable	No
Marriage Leave	5 days, once in service	On qualifying event	Not applicable	No
Compensatory Off	As earned	On approved extra work	90 days validity	No
Leave Without Pay (LWP)	Case by case	On approval	Not applicable	No

① Leave year

The leave year runs from **1 January to 31 December**. Employees joining mid-year receive CL and SL pro-rated to the number of completed months remaining in the year.

7.2 Earned Leave (EL / Privilege Leave)

- Accrues at 1.5 days for every completed month of service; credited to your balance at the end of each month.
- May be availed only after confirmation. It accrues during probation but cannot be taken until you are confirmed.
- Minimum block of 0.5 day; there is no maximum, subject to approval.
- Apply at least **7 working days** in advance for 1–3 days, and **21 days** in advance for 4 days or more.
- Up to 45 days may be carried into the next year. Anything above 45 days lapses on 31 December unless leave was refused in writing for business reasons.
- Encashed at basic salary on separation, for the balance standing to your credit.

7.3 Casual Leave (CL)

- For short, unplanned personal needs — a bank appointment, a family obligation, a delayed commute.
- Maximum **3 consecutive days** at a time. It cannot be combined with EL.

- Should be applied in advance where possible; where it is genuinely unplanned, inform your manager before your shift starts and regularise the same day you return.
- Unused CL lapses at year end and is never encashed.

7.4 Sick Leave (SL)

- For your own illness, injury, medical procedure or recovery.
- A medical certificate from a registered practitioner is required for **3 or more consecutive days**, and a fitness certificate before returning after 7 or more days.
- SL may also be used to care for a dependent child, spouse or parent who is ill, up to **5 days** per year within your overall SL entitlement.
- Up to 20 days may be carried forward, giving a maximum accumulated balance of 30 days.
- If SL is exhausted, further medical absence is adjusted against EL, and thereafter treated as LWP.

✔ Please stay home when you are unwell

Do not come to work with a fever, an infectious illness or an untreated injury. You will not earn credit for it, and you put your colleagues, learners and clients at risk. Work from home if you are well enough, or take the leave.

7.5 Maternity Benefits

Administered in line with the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961 as amended in 2017, and applicable to all women employees irrespective of length of service.

Situation	Entitlement	Notes
First and second child	26 weeks paid leave	Up to 8 weeks may be taken before the expected date of delivery
Third child onwards	12 weeks paid leave	Up to 6 weeks may be taken before delivery
Adoption (child under 3 months)	12 weeks paid leave	From the date the child is handed over
Commissioning mother	12 weeks paid leave	From the date the child is handed over
Miscarriage or medical termination	6 weeks paid leave	From the date of the event, on medical certificate
Tubectomy	2 weeks paid leave	On medical certificate
Illness arising from pregnancy	Additional 1 month	On medical certificate, over and above the above entitlements

- Nursing breaks: two paid breaks of 20 minutes each per day until the child is 15 months old, in addition to the regular break.
- Work-from-home may be agreed after maternity leave ends, for a period mutually decided with your manager, where the role permits it.
- Your role, grade and compensation are protected. No adverse action of any kind may be taken on account of pregnancy or maternity leave.
- Notify HR at least 8 weeks before your intended leave start date so cover can be planned.

7.6 Paternity, Bereavement and Marriage Leave

Paternity Leave — 10 working days

Available to fathers and to non-birthing partners, including adoptive parents. May be taken in up to two blocks within **6 months** of the birth or adoption. Apply with the birth certificate or adoption order within 30 days.

Bereavement Leave — 5 days

On the death of a spouse, child, parent, sibling, parent-in-law or grandparent. Taken as needed, without documentation. HR will not ask for proof at a time like that; your manager will simply approve it.

Marriage Leave — 5 working days

Once during your service with PROITBRIDGE, for your own marriage. Apply at least 30 days in advance. May be combined with Earned Leave for a longer break.

7.7 Public Holidays — Calendar Year 2026

PROITBRIDGE observes **12 paid holidays** per year: 8 fixed national and state holidays, plus **4 optional (floating) holidays** that you choose from the declared optional list to suit your own faith, region and family.

#	Holiday	Date	Day	Type
1	New Year's Day	1 January 2026	Thursday	Fixed
2	Pongal / Makar Sankranti	15 January 2026	Thursday	Fixed
3	Republic Day	26 January 2026	Monday	Fixed
4	Holi	4 March 2026	Wednesday	Optional
5	Ugadi / Gudi Padwa	19 March 2026	Thursday	Optional
6	Id-ul-Fitr	21 March 2026	Saturday	Optional
7	Good Friday	3 April 2026	Friday	Optional
8	Tamil New Year / Vishu	14 April 2026	Tuesday	Optional
9	May Day	1 May 2026	Friday	Optional
10	Independence Day	15 August 2026	Saturday	Fixed
11	Ganesh Chaturthi	15 September 2026	Tuesday	Optional
12	Gandhi Jayanti	2 October 2026	Friday	Fixed
13	Ayudha Puja / Dussehra	20 October 2026	Tuesday	Fixed
14	Deepavali	8 November 2026	Sunday	Fixed
15	Kannada Rajyotsava	1 November 2026	Sunday	Optional
16	Christmas Day	25 December 2026	Friday	Fixed

i Choosing your optional holidays

Declare your 4 optional holidays in the HRMS by **31 January** each year. Undeclared optional holidays cannot be claimed retrospectively. Holidays falling on a weekly off are not compensated with an alternative day.

7.8 How to Apply for Leave

1 Check your balance

Open the HRMS leave module. Your live balance, accrual and pending applications are all visible there.

2 Plan for cover

Before you apply, agree with a colleague who will cover your batches, tickets or client calls. Name that person in the application.

3 Apply in the HRMS

Select the leave type and dates, add a short reason and attach any required certificate. Verbal or WhatsApp approvals are not valid records.

4 Get approval

Your manager must approve or reject within **2 working days**. If there is no action within 5 working days, the application escalates automatically to the next level.

5 Hand over and go

Set an out-of-office message with your cover contact, complete your handover note, and switch off. We do not expect you to answer messages on approved leave.

7.9 Leave Rules That Are Often Misunderstood

Question	The Rule
Do weekends inside a leave block count?	For EL of 4 days or more, intervening weekly offs and holidays are counted as leave. For CL and SL they are not.
Can leave be cancelled after approval?	Yes, by either side. If the Company cancels approved leave and you incur a non-refundable cost, the Company reimburses it.
Can I take leave during notice period?	Only with written approval, and it does not extend or offset your notice period.
What if I overstay my leave?	Unapproved overstay is LWP and, beyond 3 days, is treated under the absence-without-information rule.
Is leave carried forward on transfer?	Yes. Balances follow you across locations, functions and entities within the group.

CHAPTER 08

Compensation & Payroll

How your salary is built, what is deducted and why, when you are paid, and how to read your payslip.

8.1 Pay Cycle

Attendance period	21st of a month to the 20th of the following month
Payroll cut-off	20th of every month — all inputs must be in the HRMS by then
Salary credit date	Last working day of each calendar month, before 6:00 PM IST
Mode	Direct bank transfer (NEFT) to your registered salary account
Payslip	Published in the HRMS by the 1st of the following month
Currency	Indian Rupees (₹)

If the last working day falls on a bank holiday, salary is credited on the preceding working day. If your salary has not reached you by the next working day, raise a payroll ticket immediately — do not wait.

8.2 How Your CTC Is Structured

Cost to Company (CTC) is the total annual cost of employing you. It is **not** your take-home. The structure below shows an illustrative ₹ 12,00,000 CTC to explain the components; your own letter will show your actual figures.

Component	Basis	Illustrative Annual (₹)	Taxable?
Basic Salary	40% of CTC	4,80,000	Fully taxable
House Rent Allowance (HRA)	50% of Basic	2,40,000	Exempt to the extent of actual rent, per Section 10(13A)
Special Allowance	Balancing figure	2,86,800	Fully taxable
Leave Travel Allowance (LTA)	8.33% of Basic	40,000	Exempt twice in a block of 4 years, on production of travel bills
Statutory Bonus	As per Payment of Bonus Act	16,800	Taxable
Employer PF Contribution	12% of Basic	57,600	Exempt within statutory limits
Gratuity Provision	4.81% of Basic	23,100	Exempt up to ₹ 20 lakh on payout
Group Insurance Premium	Company-borne	18,000	Not taxable as perquisite
Total CTC	—	11,62,300 + variable	—

8.3 Statutory Deductions Explained

Deduction	Rate	What It Is For
Employee Provident Fund (EPF)	12% of Basic	Your retirement corpus, matched by an equal employer contribution. Managed by EPFO against your UAN.
Employees' State Insurance (ESI)	0.75% of gross	Applies where gross wages are ₹ 21,000 per month or less; gives medical cover for you and your dependants. Employer adds 3.25%.
Professional Tax (PT)	State slab — up to ₹ 200/month	A state levy; the rate depends on your work location (Karnataka, Tamil Nadu and Telangana slabs differ).
Tax Deducted at Source (TDS)	As per your tax regime and slab	Income tax deducted monthly against your projected annual liability. Declare investments to reduce it.
Labour Welfare Fund (LWF)	State-specified, half-yearly	A small statutory contribution to the state welfare board.

⚠ Investment proof deadline

Submit your investment declaration in April and your **proofs by 15 January** each year. Proofs received after the cut-off cannot be adjusted in payroll — you will have to claim the refund yourself when filing your return.

8.4 Variable Pay and Incentives

Scheme	Who It Applies To	Frequency	Basis
Annual Performance Bonus	All confirmed employees, Grade 3 and above	Annual	60% company performance, 40% individual rating
Sales Incentive	Admissions counsellors, B2B sales	Monthly	Achievement against assigned quota, on realised collections
Delivery Incentive	Trainers and mentors	Per batch	Batch completion rate, learner rating, placement outcome
Project Milestone Bonus	Consulting and engineering	Per milestone	On-time, on-quality client sign-off
Spot Awards	Everyone	Monthly nomination	₹ 5,000 to ₹ 25,000 for exceptional contribution
Referral Bonus	Everyone except HR and hiring managers	On referral joining	₹ 15,000 to ₹ 75,000 depending on grade

- Variable pay is not guaranteed. It depends on both company and individual performance and is paid only if you are on the rolls and not serving notice on the payout date.
- Incentive schemes are published each year with their own scheme document, which governs calculation, caps and clawback.
- Incentives on collections are reversed if the underlying payment is refunded or charged back within 90 days.

8.5 Salary Reviews

- The annual review cycle is effective **1 April**, based on the performance year ending 31 March.

- To be eligible you must have completed 6 months of service as on 31 March and be confirmed.
- Increments reflect performance rating, market benchmark for your role, internal parity and company performance — in that order.
- Out-of-cycle corrections are made only for role changes, promotions, or documented market anomalies, and require Function Head plus Head – People approval.
- Your salary is confidential. Discussing individual salary figures with colleagues creates avoidable friction and is strongly discouraged, though never punished.

8.6 Reading Your Payslip

Section of the Payslip	What to Check Every Month
Employee details	Name, employee ID, PAN, UAN, bank account — report any error immediately
Earnings	Basic, HRA, allowances, incentives and arrears match your letter and approvals
Deductions	PF, PT, TDS, and any voluntary deduction you have authorised
Attendance summary	Paid days, LOP days, leave availed and closing leave balance
Year-to-date block	Cumulative earnings and TDS — useful for tax planning
Net pay	The amount actually credited to your account

i Raising a payroll query

Payroll queries must be raised within **30 days** of the payslip date through the HRMS ticket system. Corrections for periods older than 90 days require Finance approval and are adjusted in the following payroll run.

CHAPTER 09

Employee Benefits & Perks

Insurance, retirement, wellbeing, family support and the everyday things that make working here easier.

9.1 Insurance Cover

Policy	Sum Insured	Who Is Covered	Premium
Group Medical (Mediclaim)	₹ 5,00,000 floater	You, spouse, up to 2 children, 2 parents or parents-in-law	Company pays for you; family top-up at subsidised rate
Group Personal Accident	3 × annual CTC	Employee only	Fully company-paid
Group Term Life	3 × annual CTC	Employee only	Fully company-paid
Top-up Medical (voluntary)	Additional ₹ 10,00,000	You and enrolled dependants	Employee-paid, at group rates

- Cover starts on your date of joining — there is no waiting period for the base group policy, and pre-existing conditions are covered from day one.
- Maternity is covered up to ₹ 75,000 for a normal delivery and ₹ 1,00,000 for a caesarean, for the first two children.
- Cashless treatment is available at over 8,000 network hospitals. Carry your e-card, available in the insurer's app and the HRMS.
- Add or remove dependants within **30 days** of joining or of a life event (marriage, childbirth). Outside that window, changes wait for the annual renewal in June.
- For a planned hospitalisation, initiate pre-authorisation at least 72 hours in advance. For an emergency, inform the insurer's helpline within 24 hours of admission.

9.2 Retirement and Long-Term Benefits

Provident Fund

12% of Basic from you, matched by 12% from the Company, deposited monthly with EPFO against your UAN. Portable across employers. You may opt for Voluntary PF at a higher rate through the HRMS.

Gratuity

Payable under the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972 after **5 years** of continuous service, at 15 days' basic salary for each completed year. Paid within 30 days of separation; waived on death or permanent disablement.

National Pension System (Optional)

You may route up to 10% of Basic into NPS through payroll under Section 80CCD(2), in addition to your 80C limit. Enrol through the HRMS benefits module; the Company does not charge any administration fee.

9.3 Wellbeing

Benefit	What You Get	How to Use It
Employee Assistance Programme	6 free confidential counselling sessions per year, for you and your family	24x7 helpline; the Company never learns who called
Annual health check	Full preventive package at a network diagnostic centre	Book once per financial year through the HRMS
Mental health days	2 days per year, no reason required, not deducted from SL	Apply in the HRMS as 'Wellbeing Day'
Fitness reimbursement	₹ 12,000 per year towards gym, yoga or sports	Submit receipts once per quarter
Ergonomics support	Chair or desk reimbursement up to ₹ 15,000 for remote roles	One-time, after 6 months of service

✔ Confidentiality of counselling

Using the Employee Assistance Programme is completely confidential. The provider reports only anonymised utilisation counts to HR. Your manager will never be told, and it has no bearing on your performance record.

9.4 Family and Life-Event Support

- **Newborn / adoption gift** — ₹ 10,000 gift voucher and a personalised welcome kit.
- **Creche support** — reimbursement up to ₹ 6,000 per month per child under 6 years, in line with the Maternity Benefit Act creche provision.
- **Education support** — ₹ 25,000 per year per child towards school fees, for employees at Grade 2 and below.
- **Emergency loan** — interest-free advance of up to one month's net salary, recovered over 6 months, for medical or family emergencies.
- **Bereavement support** — immediate ex-gratia of ₹ 50,000 to the family on the death of an employee, ahead of insurance settlement.

9.5 Everyday Perks

At the Office

Subsidised cafeteria, free tea, coffee and fruit, quiet rooms, a mother's room at every location, secure parking, and a fully stocked first-aid room.

For Learning

Free access to every PROITBRIDGE course for you and one immediate family member, an O'Reilly and Coursera licence on request, and a personal certification budget (Chapter 11).

Recognition

Monthly spot awards, quarterly 'Bridge Builder' awards, annual long-service awards at 3, 5 and 10 years, and a founder's letter for exceptional contribution.

Time

Two wellbeing days, a birthday half-day, work-anniversary leave, and a no-meeting Friday afternoon across the company.

CHAPTER 10

Performance Management

How goals are set, how performance is reviewed and rated, how promotions work, and what happens when performance falls short.

10.1 The Performance Cycle

Stage	When	What Happens
Goal setting	April, or within 30 days of joining	You and your manager agree 4–6 measurable goals for the year, recorded in the HRMS
Q1 check-in	July	Light-touch progress conversation; goals may be re-weighted
Mid-year review	October	Formal written review, with a provisional rating and development plan
Q3 check-in	January	Course correction and calibration of expectations
Self-assessment	March	You write your own evidence-based assessment first
Manager review	March	Your manager rates against goals and values, with written justification
Calibration	Early April	Function-level moderation to ensure ratings mean the same thing across teams
Outcome discussion	April	Rating, increment, bonus and promotion communicated face to face

10.2 What You Are Measured On

70% — Goal Delivery

The measurable outcomes you committed to: batches delivered and their placement rate, projects shipped on time and to quality, revenue or collections achieved, system uptime, content published and its performance.

30% — Values and Behaviour

How you achieved those outcomes: integrity, ownership, respect for others, collaboration across teams, and the security and confidentiality discipline described in Chapter 13.

A person who hits every number while damaging colleagues, learners or clients does not get a top rating at PROITBRIDGE. **How you win matters as much as whether you win.**

10.3 Rating Scale

Rating	Label	Meaning	Indicative Distribution
5	Exceptional	Consistently exceeded every goal and visibly raised the standard for others	5–10%
4	Exceeds Expectations	Delivered all goals and exceeded several; a clear role model	20–25%
3	Meets Expectations	Delivered what was committed, to the expected standard	50–60%
2	Partially Meets	Missed some goals; needs a structured improvement plan	10–15%
1	Below Expectations	Missed most goals or breached values; formal action required	Under 5%

The distribution is **indicative, not enforced**. Calibration exists to keep ratings comparable across managers, not to force a quota. A team that genuinely performed exceptionally will be rated accordingly, with evidence.

10.4 Promotions

- Promotion recognises that you are already operating at the next grade — it is not a reward for time served.
- Minimum eligibility: 18 months in your current grade, a rating of 3 or above in the latest cycle and no active disciplinary proceeding.
- Your manager submits a promotion case with evidence against the next grade's competency framework; it is reviewed by the Function Head and Head – People.
- Promotions take effect on 1 April and 1 October. Off-cycle promotions require CEO approval.
- A promotion into people management is treated as a role change and includes mandatory first-time-manager training within 60 days.

10.5 Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)

A PIP is a structured, time-bound support programme, not a formality before exit. Its purpose is to give you a fair, documented chance to recover.

1 Trigger and conversation

Your manager raises specific, evidenced gaps in a documented conversation, with HR present. You get the evidence in writing before the meeting.

2 The plan

A written plan lists 3–5 measurable objectives, the support and training you will receive, weekly review dates and the review period — usually **60 days**, extendable to 90.

3 Weekly reviews

You and your manager meet weekly. Every review is minuted in the HRMS. If the support promised is not delivered, that is recorded too.

4 Outcome

Objectives met → PIP closed and normal status restored, with no lasting record against you. Partially met → one extension. Not met → role change or separation with full notice and dues.

i Your status during a PIP

During a PIP you retain every right and benefit of a regular employee: full pay, leave, insurance and the ability to apply for internal roles once the PIP is successfully closed.

CHAPTER 11

Learning & Development

The budget, the academy, certifications, mentoring and how we keep our skills ahead of the market.

11.1 Our Learning Commitment

We are a company that teaches for a living. If our own people stop learning, we lose the right to teach anyone else. Every employee is entitled to **40 hours of paid learning time** per year — treated as work, not as a favour.

11.2 Annual Learning Budget

Grade	Annual Budget	Typical Use
Grade 1 – Associate / Executive	₹ 25,000	Foundational certifications, online course subscriptions
Grade 2 – Senior Associate / Engineer	₹ 40,000	Cloud and data platform certifications, technical conferences
Grade 3 – Lead / Specialist	₹ 60,000	Advanced certifications, speaking at conferences, specialist bootcamps
Grade 4 – Manager / Principal	₹ 90,000	Leadership programmes, executive education, industry memberships
Grade 5 – Head / VP	₹ 1,50,000	Executive education, board and strategy programmes

- Apply through the HRMS learning module with a short note on how the learning connects to your role or your team's roadmap.
- Certification fees are reimbursed **on passing**; one re-attempt is covered if the first attempt was made in good faith.
- Budget is per financial year and does not carry forward.
- Any certification costing more than ₹ 75,000 carries a **12-month service commitment** from the date of certification, pro-rated on early exit.

11.3 The PROITBRIDGE Internal Academy

Free Access to Everything Every PROITBRIDGE course — Data Science, Agentic AI, Cloud, Analytics, Full Stack — is free for you and one immediate family member, in any live or recorded batch with available seats.	Teach and Be Paid Employees who deliver internal or external sessions earn a delivery honorarium over and above their salary, and delivery quality is counted in the performance review.
Friday Tech Talks Every Friday, 4:00–5:00 PM. Anyone can present anything technical they have learned. Attendance is voluntary; presenting once a year is expected of Grade 3 and above.	Shadow Programme Spend up to 5 days per year embedded with another function to understand how it works. Popular between Academy and Engineering, and between Sales and Delivery.

11.4 Mentorship

- Every employee below Grade 3 is offered a mentor from outside their own reporting line within 60 days of confirmation.
- Mentor and mentee meet at least monthly. The conversation is private and is never reported into the performance process.
- Mentors are trained in a half-day programme and their mentoring load is recognised in their own goals.
- You may change or exit a mentoring relationship at any time by informing HR, with no explanation required.

11.5 Higher Education Support

Eligibility	3 years of continuous service, rating of 3 or above in the last two cycles
Support	Up to 50% of course fees, capped at ₹ 3,00,000, for a part-time or executive programme relevant to your role
Flexibility	Adjusted working hours during examination periods, plus 5 days of paid study leave per year
Service commitment	24 months from course completion, pro-rated recovery on early exit
Approval	Function Head, Head – People and CFO, based on a written business case

CHAPTER 12

Code of Conduct & Ethics

How we behave with each other, with learners, with clients and in public.

12.1 General Standards of Conduct

Every employee is expected to:

- Act honestly and in the best interests of the Company, its learners and its clients.
- Treat every person — colleague, learner, vendor, candidate — with courtesy and dignity, regardless of designation.
- Comply with all applicable laws, and with the policies in this handbook.
- Use Company time, funds, property and information only for Company purposes.
- Report any conduct that appears illegal, unethical or unsafe, promptly and without fear.
- Cooperate fully and truthfully with any internal investigation or audit.

12.2 Conduct That Will Result in Disciplinary Action

Category	Examples	Typical Consequence
Dishonesty	Falsifying records, timesheets, expense claims, attendance or qualifications	Termination for cause
Theft or misuse	Taking Company or client property, misusing funds or licences	Termination and legal action
Harassment	Sexual harassment, bullying, discriminatory conduct, retaliation	Termination; POSH process (Chapter 15)
Confidentiality breach	Disclosing client, learner or Company confidential information	Termination and legal action
Intoxication	Reporting to work or client site under the influence of alcohol or drugs	Suspension pending inquiry, then termination
Violence	Physical assault, threats, intimidation, carrying weapons on premises	Immediate suspension, termination and police report
Insubordination	Wilful refusal to carry out a lawful instruction	Written warning to termination, based on severity
Negligence	Careless acts causing loss, injury or reputational damage	Warning to termination, based on impact
Conflict of interest	Undisclosed personal benefit from a Company decision	Warning to termination, plus recovery

12.3 Dress Code

Everyday — Smart Casual

Clean, neat, presentable clothing. Jeans, t-shirts, kurtas and sneakers are all fine. We care that you look like a professional someone would trust, not that you look like a bank.

Client, Camera or Batch Days — Business Casual

Collared shirt or formal top, trousers or formal skirt, closed shoes. Trainers on camera and anyone at a client site or an external event follow this standard by default.

- Not acceptable at any time: clothing with offensive slogans or imagery, beachwear, sleepwear, and anything unsafe for the environment you are working in.
- Religious and cultural attire is always welcome and never a dress-code issue.
- Fridays are casual across the company, except where you have a client commitment.

12.4 Conflict of Interest

A conflict of interest arises whenever your personal interest could improperly influence — or appear to influence — a decision you take for PROITBRIDGE. The rule is simple: **declare it, then step out of the decision.**

Situation	What You Must Do
A relative or close friend applies for a role you influence	Declare it in writing; recuse yourself from screening, interviewing and the decision
You hold a stake in a vendor, client or competitor	Declare it annually in the conflict register; recuse yourself from related procurement
You are offered a personal benefit by a vendor or client	Decline it, and report the offer to your Function Head within 48 hours
You want to hire the company of a relative as a vendor	Declare it; the selection must be run by someone else, with three comparative quotes
You are in a personal relationship with a colleague	If either of you reports to the other, declare it to HR — the reporting line will be changed, not the relationship

12.5 Gifts, Hospitality and Anti-Bribery

- PROITBRIDGE has **zero tolerance** for bribery and corruption, in any form, in any country, including facilitation payments.
- You may accept ordinary business hospitality — a meal, a branded item — of a value up to **₹ 2,500**, and must log anything above ₹ 1,000 in the gift register.
- Cash, gift cards, vouchers and personal discounts may never be accepted, at any value.
- Gifts to government officials of any value require prior written approval from the Head – Legal.
- Political contributions may never be made on behalf of the Company. Your personal political activity is your own, provided it is not conducted using Company time, resources or identity.

12.6 Social Media and Public Statements

Encouraged

Share what you learn, celebrate your team's wins, post about the technology you work with, and speak at meet-ups and conferences. Your visibility is our visibility.

Not Permitted

Sharing client names, screenshots, learner data, internal documents, unreleased features or financial information. Speaking as if you represent the Company when you have not been authorised to.

- Only the CEO, the Head – Content and designated spokespersons may speak to the press on behalf of PROITBRIDGE. Route all media queries to press@proitbridge.com.
- If you post about your work, use your own voice and add the line: 'Views are my own.'
- Never respond publicly to criticism of the Company, a learner complaint or a client dispute. Forward it to the Content team, who will handle it.
- Do not post photographs taken inside client premises or of client-owned screens, whiteboards or documents.

12.7 Substance Policy

- PROITBRIDGE premises, vehicles and client sites are alcohol-free and drug-free at all times.
- Alcohol may be served at authorised company events; consumption must remain moderate and driving after drinking is prohibited — the Company will pay for your cab.
- Smoking and vaping are permitted only in designated areas, in line with the Cigarettes and Other Tobacco Products Act, 2003.
- If you are dependent on a substance, tell HR. Voluntary disclosure before any incident leads to support and treatment, not to discipline.

CHAPTER 13

Information Security & Data Privacy

Protecting Company, client and learner information — the obligations that keep our business alive.

13.1 Why This Chapter Matters More Than Any Other

A single leaked client dataset can end a contract, trigger regulatory penalties under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, and destroy trust we spent years building. Security is not the IT team's job. **It is yours.**

13.2 Information Classification

Classification	Examples	Handling Rule
Public	Marketing material, published course outlines, press releases	Share freely
Internal	Org charts, internal processes, this handbook, meeting notes	Share within the Company only
Confidential	Client contracts, pricing, source code, learner records, salary data	Need-to-know only; encrypted at rest and in transit
Restricted	Client production data, personal data, credentials, security keys	Named-individual access, logged, MFA-protected, never copied locally

13.3 Acceptable Use of Company Systems

- Company email, devices, networks and accounts are provided for business use. Incidental personal use is tolerated, and carries no expectation of privacy.
- The Company may monitor, log and audit use of its systems for security, compliance and investigation purposes, in accordance with law.
- Never install unlicensed, cracked or unapproved software. Requests go to IT through the software request form.
- Never connect an unknown USB device to a Company machine.
- Do not use personal cloud storage, personal email or personal messaging apps to move Company or client data. Use the approved Company workspace.
- Lock your screen every time you step away. Automatic lock is set to 5 minutes and may not be disabled.

13.4 Passwords, Access and Devices

Control	The Standard
Password length	Minimum 14 characters, or a passphrase of four or more words
Password manager	Mandatory — the Company-provided vault. Never reuse a password across systems
Multi-factor authentication	Mandatory on email, VPN, cloud consoles, code repositories and the HRMS
Disk encryption	Full-disk encryption enabled on every laptop; verified quarterly
Patching	Operating system and browser updates applied within 7 days of release
Screen lock	5-minute automatic lock, with password or biometric to resume
Lost or stolen device	Report to IT and your manager within 4 hours — the device is remote-wiped
Access review	Managers recertify their team's access every quarter; unused access is revoked

13.5 Handling Client and Learner Data

- Access client data only when a live task requires it, and only through approved systems — never by downloading a copy to your laptop.
- Production data may not be used for training, demonstrations, testing or course content. Use masked, synthetic or anonymised data.
- Learner personal data — names, phone numbers, marks, payment details — is personal data under the DPDP Act, 2023 and may be processed only for the purpose it was collected for.
- Never share a learner's contact list, a client's employee list or any personal data with an external party, including a recruiter or partner, without written consent and a signed data-processing agreement.
- Delete or return client data at the end of an engagement, and record the deletion.
- Data-subject requests (access, correction, erasure) must be forwarded to privacy@proitbridge.com within 24 hours of receipt.

13.6 Use of Artificial Intelligence Tools

We build with AI and we teach AI, so we use AI tools every day. That makes disciplined use more important here, not less.

Green — Go Ahead

Approved enterprise AI accounts for drafting, summarising, brainstorming, code assistance on internal repositories, and generating synthetic test data. Zero-retention settings are enforced on these accounts.

Red — Never

Pasting client data, learner personal data, credentials, unreleased financials or proprietary source code into a personal or free-tier AI tool. Using AI output as a final deliverable without human review.

- You remain fully accountable for anything you produce with AI assistance. “The model wrote it” is not a defence for an error, a fabricated fact or a licence violation.
- AI-generated content used in courseware or client deliverables must be reviewed, corrected and factually verified by a named human owner.
- Do not use AI tools to evaluate learners, screen candidates or make any decision affecting a person's employment or grades without human review and a documented rationale.
- The list of approved tools is maintained on the IT portal and updated monthly.

13.7 Phishing and Incident Reporting

1 Recognise it

Urgency, an unexpected attachment, a request for credentials or payment, a sender address that is nearly right, or a message that pressures you to bypass a process.

2 Do not engage

Do not click, do not reply, do not open the attachment, and never enter credentials on a page you reached from an email link.

3 Report in minutes

Use the **Report Phishing** button in your mail client, or write to security@proitbridge.com. Reporting is always the right call, even if you turn out to be wrong.

4 If you already clicked

Disconnect from the network, call the security hotline immediately, and change your password from a different device. There is **no penalty** for reporting your own mistake quickly — there is one for hiding it.

⚠ The 4-hour rule

All security incidents — suspected breach, lost device, misdirected email containing personal data, unauthorised access — must be reported within **4 hours** of discovery. Legal breach-notification clocks start ticking from the moment of discovery, not the moment you get around to it.

13.8 Confidentiality Obligations After You Leave

- Your confidentiality obligations survive the end of your employment, indefinitely for trade secrets and for the period specified in your NDA for other confidential information.
- All work created in the course of your employment — code, courseware, designs, documentation, recordings — is the property of PROITBRIDGE.
- On separation you must return every copy of Company and client information, including anything on personal devices or personal cloud accounts, and sign a confirmation to that effect.

CHAPTER 14

Workplace Health & Safety

Keeping people physically safe at our offices, our studios and on the road.

14.1 Our Safety Commitment

PROITBRIDGE provides a safe and healthy workplace in compliance with the applicable Shops and Establishments Acts and occupational safety rules. Safety is a shared duty: the Company provides the systems, and every employee is expected to use them.

14.2 General Safety Rules

- Know the location of the nearest fire exit, extinguisher, first-aid box and assembly point at every location you work from.
- Keep walkways, exits and electrical panels clear at all times.
- Report any unsafe condition — frayed cable, wet floor, blocked exit, faulty equipment — to the Admin helpdesk immediately.
- Visitors must be registered at reception, issued a badge and escorted at all times.
- Do not prop open secure doors or allow tailgating through access-controlled entries.
- Follow studio-specific rules for lighting rigs, cabling and heavy equipment in the content production areas.

14.3 Emergency Procedures

Emergency	What to Do	Whom to Call
Fire	Raise the alarm, leave by the nearest exit, do not use the lift, go to the assembly point, wait for the roll call	Fire warden, then 101
Medical emergency	Do not move the person unless there is danger; call the first-aider; keep the area clear	First-aider, then 108
Earthquake	Drop, cover and hold. Evacuate only after the shaking stops, using the stairs	Floor warden
Security threat	Do not confront. Move to a safe area and inform security	Security desk, then 100
Power or system failure	Save work if safe, follow the wardens, do not use lifts	Admin helpdesk

i Drills

Evacuation drills are conducted twice a year at every location. Participation is mandatory for everyone on the premises, including visitors and contractors.

14.4 First Aid and Medical Support

- Every location has at least two trained first-aiders per floor; their names and desk numbers are posted at the entrance and near the lifts.
- First-aid boxes are checked monthly by Admin and restocked immediately after any use.
- An automated external defibrillator (AED) is installed at the Bengaluru and Chennai reception areas.
- Any injury at work — however minor — must be logged in the incident register within 24 hours.

14.5 Ergonomics and Screen Work

- Adjust your chair so your feet are flat and your elbows are at desk height; the top of your screen should be at or just below eye level.
- Follow the 20-20-20 rule: every 20 minutes, look at something 20 feet away for 20 seconds.
- Stand and move for at least 5 minutes every hour. Walking meetings are encouraged.
- Request an ergonomic assessment through Admin if you experience discomfort; equipment adjustments are provided at Company cost.

14.6 Road and Travel Safety

- Helmets and seat belts are mandatory in Company-provided transport and on Company business.
- Never take a call or read messages while driving on Company business.
- Night-shift transport is escorted; the vehicle may not drop a woman employee last on the route.
- Share your live location with your manager when travelling alone to an unfamiliar client site.

CHAPTER 15

Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH)

Our zero-tolerance policy under the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013.

15.1 Policy Statement

⚠ Zero tolerance

PROITBRIDGE has zero tolerance for sexual harassment. Every person at our workplace has the right to work with dignity and free from harassment. Any complaint will be taken seriously, handled confidentially and acted upon.

This policy is framed under the POSH Act, 2013 and its Rules. While the Act protects women, PROITBRIDGE extends the **same protection, process and remedies to every employee** regardless of gender, gender identity or sexual orientation, through an internally equivalent process.

15.2 What Constitutes Sexual Harassment

Any unwelcome act or behaviour, whether directly or by implication, including:

- Physical contact and advances of a sexual nature
- A demand or request for sexual favours
- Sexually coloured remarks, jokes, comments about appearance or body
- Showing pornography or sexually explicit material
- Any other unwelcome physical, verbal or non-verbal conduct of a sexual nature — including messages, emails, images, stalking and unwanted attention online

The Act also recognises the following circumstances as harassment:

- Implied or explicit promise of preferential treatment in employment
- Implied or explicit threat of detrimental treatment in employment
- Implied or explicit threat about present or future employment status
- Interference with work, or creating an intimidating, offensive or hostile work environment
- Humiliating treatment likely to affect health or safety

📌 Where this policy applies

“Workplace” is not just the office. It includes client sites, training venues, studios, transport provided by the Company, offsites, work events, and virtual spaces — video calls, chat groups and email.

15.3 The Internal Committee (IC)

Role	Held By	Contact
Presiding Officer (senior woman employee)	Head – Academy	posh.po@proitbridge.com
Member — Employee representative	Senior Manager, Engineering	posh.ic@proitbridge.com
Member — Employee representative	Lead, Placements	posh.ic@proitbridge.com
External Member (NGO / legal expert)	Independent advocate specialising in workplace law	Via the Presiding Officer
Secretariat	Head – People (non-voting)	posh.ic@proitbridge.com

At least half of the IC members are women, and the Presiding Officer is always a senior woman employee, as required by the Act. Members are appointed for three years and are trained annually.

15.4 How to Make a Complaint

1 File the complaint

In writing to any IC member, by email or on paper, within **3 months** of the incident (or of the last incident in a series). The IC may extend this by a further 3 months for good reason. If you cannot write it yourself, any IC member will help you record it.

2 Conciliation (optional)

At your request only, the IC may attempt conciliation before an inquiry. No monetary settlement may form the basis of conciliation, and you are never obliged to accept it.

3 Inquiry

The IC completes its inquiry within **90 days**. Both parties get a fair hearing, may present witnesses and documents, and may not directly cross-examine each other — questions are put through the IC.

4 Interim relief

During the inquiry you may request a transfer, the respondent's transfer, leave of up to 3 months over and above your entitlement, or restraint on the respondent from reporting on your work.

5 Report and action

The IC submits its report within 10 days of completing the inquiry. The Company acts on the recommendations within **60 days**. Either party may appeal to the appropriate authority within 90 days.

15.5 Consequences and Protections

If a Complaint Is Upheld

Consequences range from a written apology and warning to withholding of increment or promotion, transfer, termination, and deduction of compensation payable to the complainant from the respondent's salary.

Protection From Retaliation

Retaliation against a complainant, witness or IC member is itself a serious disciplinary offence, treated with the same severity as the original complaint.

- **Confidentiality is absolute.** The identity of the complainant, respondent and witnesses, and the contents of the inquiry, may not be published or disclosed. Breach attracts a penalty under the Act and disciplinary action here.
- A complaint made in good faith that is not proved will **never** be held against the complainant.
- A complaint proven to be malicious and knowingly false may attract disciplinary action — but inability to prove a complaint is not, by itself, malice.
- The Company files the annual POSH report with the District Officer and includes the number of complaints received and disposed of in its Board report, as required by law.

CHAPTER 16

Grievance Redressal & Discipline

How to raise a concern, how disciplinary matters are handled, and how to appeal.

16.1 Raising a Grievance

Level	Whom to Approach	Response Time
Level 1	Your reporting manager — for most day-to-day issues	3 working days
Level 2	Your HR Business Partner — in writing, if Level 1 does not resolve it	7 working days
Level 3	Head – People — formal grievance with all documentation	15 working days
Level 4	Grievance Committee (Function Head, Head – People, one peer)	30 working days
Direct	Ethics hotline — for fraud, safety, harassment or ethical violations	Acknowledged in 24 hours

- You may skip levels entirely where the grievance concerns your own manager, or involves harassment, fraud, safety or a legal violation.
- Every formal grievance is acknowledged in writing, logged with a reference number and tracked to closure.
- You may bring a colleague of your choice to any grievance meeting as a support person.

16.2 Whistleblower Protection

Any employee may report a suspected violation of law, policy or ethics through the ethics hotline at ethics@proitbridge.com or the anonymous web form on the HR portal.

- Reports may be made anonymously. Where you identify yourself, your identity is disclosed only to the investigating authority, on a need-to-know basis.
- No employee who reports in good faith will suffer any adverse consequence — retaliation is itself a terminable offence.
- Reports involving the CEO or a Board member go directly to the Chair of the Audit Committee.

16.3 Disciplinary Process

1 Preliminary review

HR establishes whether the allegation, if true, would amount to misconduct. Frivolous matters are closed with a note on file.

2 Show-cause notice

You receive a written notice setting out the specific allegations and the evidence relied on, with at least **7 days** to respond in writing.

3 Inquiry

Where the matter is contested or serious, an inquiry panel of at least three people, none of whom is a witness or complainant, hears both sides. You may be accompanied by a colleague.

4 Decision

The panel records findings and recommends action. The decision is communicated to you in writing with reasons, within 10 working days of the inquiry ending.

5 Appeal

You may appeal to the Head – People, or to the CEO where the Head – People decided the matter, within **15 days**. The appeal decision is final within the Company.

16.4 Scale of Disciplinary Action

Action	When It Is Used	Record
Verbal counselling	First, minor lapse — a coaching conversation	Manager's note; not on the personnel file
Written warning	Repeated minor lapse or a first moderate breach	Personnel file, 12 months
Final written warning	Repeat after a written warning, or a serious breach	Personnel file, 24 months; affects rating
Suspension pending inquiry	Where presence could obstruct an inquiry or endanger others	Subsistence allowance paid as per law
Withholding of increment / promotion	Serious breach with continued employment	One review cycle
Termination for cause	Gross misconduct, or repeat after a final warning	Permanent; no notice pay

i Natural justice

Principles of natural justice apply to every disciplinary matter: you will always know the specific allegation, see the evidence against you, have a real opportunity to respond, and receive a decision from someone who was not the complainant.

CHAPTER 17

Travel & Expense Policy

Approvals, entitlements, booking rules and how to claim reimbursement.

17.1 Before You Travel

- All business travel requires a travel request in the HRMS, approved by your manager before booking — at least **7 days** in advance for domestic travel and **21 days** for international.
- All bookings must go through the Company's travel desk. Self-booked travel is reimbursed only at the lower of actual cost and the travel desk's quoted fare.
- International travel additionally requires Function Head and Finance approval, plus a valid passport, visa and travel insurance arranged by the travel desk.
- Combine business travel with personal leave only with prior approval; the Company pays only the business portion.

17.2 Travel Entitlements

Grade	Air Travel	Rail	Hotel per Night (Metro)	Local Transport
Grade 1-2	Economy, lowest logical fare	AC 3-Tier / Chair Car	₹ 4,500	Cab, app-based, standard category
Grade 3	Economy, lowest logical fare	AC 2-Tier	₹ 6,500	Cab, app-based, standard category
Grade 4	Economy; premium economy above 6 hours	AC 1st Class	₹ 9,000	Cab, app-based, any category
Grade 5	Business above 6 hours	AC 1st Class	₹ 12,000	Cab, app-based, any category

Hotel limits for non-metro cities are 70% of the metro figure. Where a client mandates a specific hotel, the client's standard applies and the difference is billed to the engagement.

17.3 Daily Allowance

Location	Grade 1-2	Grade 3	Grade 4-5
Metro cities in India	₹ 1,200 / day	₹ 1,600 / day	₹ 2,200 / day
Other cities in India	₹ 900 / day	₹ 1,200 / day	₹ 1,600 / day
International — Asia / Middle East	USD 45 / day	USD 60 / day	USD 80 / day
International — Europe / Americas	USD 65 / day	USD 85 / day	USD 110 / day

- Daily allowance covers meals and incidental expenses and does not require bills.
- Where meals are provided by the client, the conference or the hotel, the allowance is reduced by one-third per meal provided.
- Half-day allowance applies where travel is under 8 hours and does not involve an overnight stay.

17.4 Claiming Reimbursement

1 Submit within 15 days

File the claim in the HRMS within **15 days** of returning. Claims older than 45 days need Finance Head approval and may be declined.

2 Attach originals

Upload legible scans of every bill above ₹ 500, boarding passes, hotel folios and the approved travel request. GST-compliant invoices in the Company's name are required wherever available.

3 Approval and payment

Your manager approves within 3 working days and Finance settles with the next payroll cycle, or within 10 working days for claims above ₹ 50,000.

⚠ Expense integrity

Inflated, duplicated or fabricated expense claims are treated as fraud, not as an error — regardless of the amount involved. The consequence is termination for cause and recovery of the amount.

17.5 What Is Not Reimbursed

- Alcohol, tobacco, entertainment and personal shopping
- Fines, traffic penalties and parking tickets
- Hotel room upgrades, spa, laundry beyond 3 nights, and mini-bar
- Travel for family members accompanying you
- Loss of personal belongings (claim through insurance instead)
- Any expense incurred before approval was granted

CHAPTER 18

Remote & Hybrid Work

Where you work from, what we provide, and what we expect in return.

18.1 Work Models

Model	Office Presence	Typical Roles	Approval
On-site	5 days a week	Studio, lab, front-desk, hardware and facilities roles	Default for the role
Hybrid	3 days a week (Tue–Thu anchor days)	Most engineering, academy, product and support roles	Manager
Remote-first	2 days a month	Distributed teams, content writers, some engineering	Function Head
Fully remote	As required for events	Roles hired explicitly as remote	Function Head + Head – People

18.2 Eligibility and Expectations

- Remote and hybrid working is a way of working, not a benefit or an entitlement, and it may be varied for genuine business reasons with 30 days' notice.
- You must have a stable internet connection of at least **50 Mbps**, a quiet space suitable for calls, and a working camera for meetings.
- Be available and responsive during core hours (11:00 AM – 4:00 PM IST), and keep your calendar and status accurate.
- Work only from the address you have registered with HR. Working from another state or country, even briefly, requires prior approval because of tax and compliance implications.
- Remote working is not a substitute for childcare or eldercare. Use the leave and support policies in Chapters 7 and 9 for those needs.

18.3 What the Company Provides

Equipment

An encrypted laptop, a headset, and on request a monitor and keyboard. One-time ergonomics reimbursement of up to ₹ 15,000 after 6 months of service.

Connectivity

Internet allowance of ₹ 1,500 per month for hybrid roles and ₹ 2,500 per month for remote-first roles, paid with salary and taxable as per law.

Co-working

Where no Company office exists in your city, a co-working day pass up to 8 days a month, booked through Admin.

Travel to Office

Fully remote employees required to attend an offsite, planning week or event have travel and stay covered per Chapter 17.

18.4 Security When Working Remotely

- Always connect through the Company VPN when accessing internal systems.

- Never work on client-confidential material in a public space where your screen is visible; use a privacy filter if you must.
- Secure your home Wi-Fi with WPA3 or WPA2 and a strong, unique password. Never use an open public network without the VPN.
- Family members and flatmates may never use your work device, even briefly.
- Lock your device whenever you step away, including at home.

CHAPTER 19

Communication & Workplace Norms

Which channel to use, how we run meetings, and how things get escalated.

19.1 Choosing the Right Channel

Channel	Use It For	Expected Response
Email	External communication, formal decisions, anything that needs a record	1 working day
Chat — direct message	Quick internal questions, coordination	Within core hours, same day
Chat — team channel	Team-wide updates, decisions others should see	Same day
Ticketing system	IT, HR, Finance and Admin requests	Per the service-level target on the ticket
Video call	Discussion, design, feedback, anything with nuance or emotion	Scheduled
Phone call	Urgent and time-critical only	Immediate

✔ Right to disconnect

There is no expectation that you respond to messages outside your working hours, on leave, or on a weekly off. If something is genuinely urgent, it warrants a phone call — and those should be rare.

19.2 Meeting Norms

- Every meeting invite must carry an agenda and a named owner. No agenda, no meeting.
- Default to 25 and 50 minutes rather than 30 and 60, so people can move between calls.
- Only invite people who need to decide or contribute. Everyone else gets the notes.
- Decisions and actions are written up within 24 hours, with an owner and a date.
- Cameras on for the first five minutes and for any discussion involving feedback; after that it is your call.
- **Friday afternoons are meeting-free** across the company, for deep work.

19.3 Escalation Matrix

Issue Type	First Contact	Escalate To	Final Escalation
IT / access / device	IT helpdesk ticket	Manager – IT	Head – Engineering
Payroll / reimbursement	Payroll ticket	Payroll Lead	Head – Finance
Leave / policy	HR Business Partner	HR Manager	Head – People
Client delivery issue	Engagement Manager	Delivery Head	VP – Engineering
Learner complaint	Batch Mentor	Academy Manager	VP – Academy
Safety incident	Admin helpdesk	Facilities Manager	Head – People
Harassment / ethics	IC member or ethics hotline	—	Audit Committee

19.4 Working With Learners and Clients

- Never promise a placement, a salary figure, a refund or a delivery date that has not been formally approved. Everything we promise, we must be able to keep.
- Respond to a learner query within one working day, even if the answer is 'I am checking and will confirm by Thursday.'
- Escalate an unhappy learner or client early. A problem raised on day one is a conversation; the same problem on day thirty is a refund request.
- Keep all client and learner communication on Company channels so it is recorded and recoverable. Personal WhatsApp is not a Company channel.

CHAPTER 20

Employee Separation

Resignation, notice periods, handover, exit formalities and full-and-final settlement.

20.1 Types of Separation

Type	Initiated By	Notice	Settlement
Resignation	Employee	60 days (confirmed) / 30 days (probation)	Full and final within 45 days of the last working day
Termination without cause	Company	60 days or salary in lieu	Full and final including notice pay
Termination for cause	Company	Immediate, after due process	Dues less recoveries; no notice pay
End of fixed-term contract	Automatic	As per contract	Full and final on the end date
Retirement	Automatic at 58 years	6 months' planning	Gratuity, PF, leave encashment, farewell
Abandonment	Deemed	After show-cause process	Dues less recoveries

20.2 Resignation Process

1 Submit in the HRMS

Resign through the HRMS, addressed to your reporting manager. An email or a verbal conversation alone does not start the notice clock.

2 Notice period

60 days for confirmed employees, 30 days on probation. The Company may waive part of the notice; you may buy out notice only with Function Head approval, at basic salary for the shortfall.

3 Handover

Complete a written handover document covering live work, credentials, contacts, pending decisions and known risks. Handover is verified and signed by your manager.

4 Asset return and clearance

Return every Company asset and obtain clearance from IT, Finance, Admin, the Library and your manager on the exit checklist.

5 Exit interview

A confidential conversation with HR in your final week. Themes are shared with leadership in aggregate; individual comments are never attributed.

20.3 Exit Checklist

- ☐ Handover document completed and signed off by the reporting manager
- ☐ Laptop, access card, peripherals and any other asset returned
- ☐ All Company and client data returned or deleted, with written confirmation
- ☐ Personal files removed from Company systems; no Company data on personal devices

- ☐ Expense claims and advances submitted and settled
- ☐ Company credit card and any corporate subscription surrendered
- ☐ Email auto-forward and delegate access set up for the transition owner
- ☐ Exit interview attended
- ☐ Confidentiality and IP acknowledgement re-signed
- ☐ Personal contact details and forwarding address updated for Form 16 and PF

20.4 Full and Final Settlement

Included in Your Settlement	Deducted From Your Settlement
Salary for days worked in the final month	Notice period shortfall, if any
Encashment of Earned Leave balance	Outstanding advances and loans
Pro-rated statutory bonus	Unreturned or damaged assets, at book value
Gratuity, if 5 years of service completed	Pro-rated recovery of certification or education bonds
Reimbursements approved before the last working day	Excess leave availed beyond entitlement
Variable pay declared before the last working day	Statutory dues — TDS, PT

- Settlement is completed and paid within **45 days** of your last working day.
- Your relieving letter and experience certificate are issued within 7 working days of clearance being complete.
- Form 16 is issued by 15 June following the end of the financial year.
- PF may be withdrawn or transferred through the EPFO portal using your UAN; HR will attest the claim within 5 working days of your request.
- Insurance cover ends on your last working day; you may port the group policy to an individual policy within 30 days.

20.5 Rehire

- Former employees who left in good standing after serving full notice are eligible for rehire, and are actively welcomed.
- Rehire within 12 months restores your original date of joining for the purpose of leave accrual and gratuity, subject to statutory rules.
- Employees terminated for cause, or who abandoned employment, are not eligible for rehire.

CHAPTER 21

Frequently Asked Questions

The questions HR is asked most, answered in one place.

Joining, Probation and Documents

Q. When exactly does my probation end?

A. 90 calendar days from your date of joining, unless your appointment letter says otherwise. You receive the confirmation decision in writing within 10 working days of that date.

Q. I have not received my relieving letter from my previous employer. Can I still join?

A. Yes, on submitting a written undertaking with a committed date. Your background verification will show as pending until it is received.

Q. Can I get a salary certificate or an address proof letter?

A. Yes. Raise an HR letter request in the HRMS; standard letters are issued within 3 working days.

Leave and Attendance

Q. Can I take Earned Leave while on probation?

A. No. EL accrues from your first month but can only be availed after confirmation. Use Casual or Sick Leave during probation.

Q. My manager has not approved my leave application. What happens?

A. If there is no action within 5 working days, the application escalates automatically to the next level in the HRMS.

Q. Do public holidays inside a long leave count against my balance?

A. For Earned Leave of 4 days or more, yes — intervening holidays and weekly offs are counted. For Casual and Sick Leave, no.

Q. I forgot to check in for three days last month. Can I fix it?

A. Regularise within 3 working days in the HRMS. Beyond that, your manager must raise an exception with HR, and unresolved days become Loss of Pay.

Q. Can I encash Casual or Sick Leave?

A. No. Only Earned Leave is encashable, and only at the time of separation.

Salary, Tax and Reimbursement

Q. When will my salary be credited?

A. On the last working day of every month, before 6:00 PM IST. If that falls on a bank holiday, it is credited on the preceding working day.

Q. Why is my take-home much lower than my CTC divided by twelve?

A. CTC includes employer PF, gratuity provision and insurance premium, which are costs to the Company but not part of your monthly cash. Deductions for PF, professional tax and TDS reduce it further. Chapter 8 shows a worked example.

Q. I missed the investment proof deadline. What now?

A. Payroll cannot adjust it after 15 January. You can still claim the deduction when you file your own income tax return and receive the refund from the department.

Q. How long does a reimbursement take?

A. Manager approval within 3 working days, then settlement with the next payroll cycle; claims above ₹ 50,000 are paid within 10 working days.

Benefits and Insurance

Q. Are my parents covered under the medical policy?

A. Yes — either your parents or your parents-in-law, up to two people, may be enrolled. Enrol within 30 days of joining or of a qualifying life event.

Q. Is there a waiting period for pre-existing conditions?

A. No. The group policy covers pre-existing conditions from your date of joining.

Q. How do I use the counselling programme without HR finding out?

A. Call the 24x7 helpline directly. The provider shares only anonymised utilisation counts with the Company; no names are ever disclosed.

Q. When do I become eligible for gratuity?

A. After 5 years of continuous service. It is paid within 30 days of separation, and the 5-year condition is waived in case of death or permanent disablement.

Performance and Growth

Q. I joined in November. Will I get an increment in April?

A. You need 6 months of service as on 31 March to be eligible, so a November joiner is eligible but the increment is pro-rated for the part-year.

Q. Is a rating of 3 a bad rating?

A. No. A 3 means you delivered what you committed, to the expected standard. That is the rating most people should receive in a healthy organisation.

Q. Does a PIP mean I am being managed out?

A. No. A PIP is a structured 60-day support plan with weekly reviews. A successfully closed PIP leaves no lasting record and restores your full status.

Q. Can I apply for an internal role without telling my manager?

A. You may apply confidentially, but you must inform your manager before the second interview round. Managers cannot block an internal application.

Conduct, Security and Exit

Q. Can I use ChatGPT or another AI tool for my work?

A. Yes — through the approved enterprise accounts, for the green-list uses in Chapter 13. Never paste client data, learner personal data, credentials or proprietary code into a personal or free-tier tool.

Q. I clicked a phishing link. Will I be punished?

A. No, provided you report it immediately. Disconnect, call the security hotline and change your password. There is no penalty for reporting quickly — there is one for hiding it.

Q. Can I teach a paid course on my own outside PROITBRIDGE?

A. If it is on the same subject matter you teach or deliver here, you need written approval from your Function Head. Unrelated teaching in personal time does not need approval.

Q. Can I take leave during my notice period?

A. Only with written approval, and it does not extend or offset your notice period.

Q. How long does the full and final settlement take?

A. Within 45 days of your last working day, provided clearance is complete. Your relieving letter is issued within 7 working days of clearance.

Q. I left PROITBRIDGE two years ago. Can I come back?

A. Yes, if you left in good standing after serving full notice. Rehire within 12 months even restores your original date of joining for leave and gratuity purposes.

CHAPTER 22

Acknowledgement & Declaration

Please read, sign and return this page to the People team within 7 days of receiving this handbook.

Employee Declaration

I confirm that I have received, read and understood the PROITBRIDGE Employee Handbook, Version 6.0, effective 1 April 2026. In particular, I confirm that:

- 1. I understand this handbook is a statement of Company policy and practice and does not constitute a contract of employment, and that my appointment letter prevails where its specific terms differ.
2. I understand that PROITBRIDGE may amend these policies from time to time, and that the version published on the HR portal is the authoritative version in force.
3. I have read and understood the Code of Conduct and Ethics in Chapter 12, including the provisions on conflict of interest, gifts, anti-bribery and secondary employment, and I agree to be bound by them.
4. I have read and understood the Information Security and Data Privacy obligations in Chapter 13, including the rules on client data, personal data and the use of artificial intelligence tools, and I agree to comply with them during and after my employment.
5. I have attended, or will attend within 30 days, the mandatory induction on the Prevention of Sexual Harassment (Chapter 15), and I understand how to raise a complaint and that retaliation is prohibited.
6. I understand the leave, attendance, compensation and separation policies that apply to me, and my obligation to return all Company property and information on separation.
7. I understand that any breach of these policies may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment and legal action.
8. I confirm that all information provided by me in my application, declarations and supporting documents is true, complete and accurate.

Signature

Please complete in ink, sign, and return the signed page to people@proitbridge.com or hand it to your HR Business Partner.

Employee Name (in block letters) Employee ID
Designation Department / Function
Date of Joining Work Location
Employee Signature Date
Received by (HR) — Name and Signature Date of Receipt

END OF DOCUMENT

PROITBRIDGE Technologies Private Limited | Employee Handbook, Version 6.0 | Document ID: PIB-HR-HB-2026-V6 | Effective 1 April 2026 | Next review: 1 April 2027.

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